VS Code Python Execution Setup

Making Scripts Run in their Own Directory

By default, running a Python script in VS Code might execute it relative to your main workspace folder. Modifying this setting ensures that the Run button (▷) always starts the terminal exactly where the script is located. This prevents "file not found" errors when loading local datasets or modules.

1. Configuration Steps

Follow these instructions to update your VS Code workspace or user settings.

Action	Description & Notes
`Ctrl + ,`	Opens the Settings tab (Alternatively: *File* > *Preferences* > *Settings*).
`Search`	In the search bar at the top, type exactly: `Execute In File Dir`.
`Tick Setting`	Look for the setting named **Python > Terminal: Execute In File Dir** and tick the checkbox.

2. Why is this important?

Configuring your environment this way provides several major advantages for later assignments and your own scripts:

- **Reliable Relative Paths:** You can safely use commands like `open("data.csv")` or `pandas.read_csv("dat` The script will look in its own folder rather than the root of your project folder.
- **Better Project Organization:** As our Data Engineering projects grow to include multiple sub-folders for different exercises, this setting ensures each script behaves independently.
- **Standard Terminal Behavior:** It replicates how a script would behave if you manually navigated to its directory in a standard command prompt before running it.